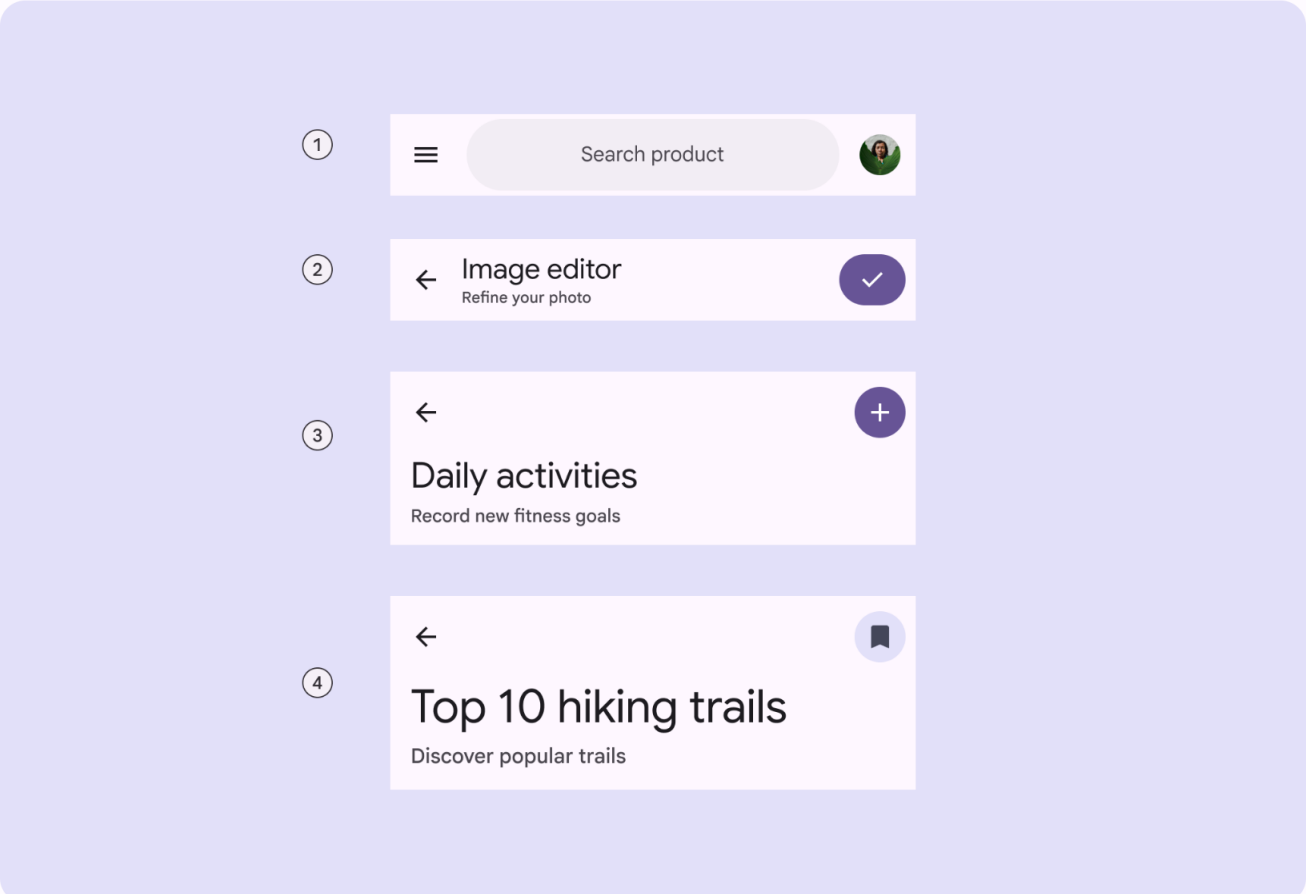
App bars

App bars are placed at the top of the screen to help people navigate through a product

Resources +3

- Focus on describing the current page and provide 1–2 essential actions
- Displays labels and page navigation controls at the top of the page. (Use a toolbar to display page actions)
- Four variants: Search app bar, small, medium flexible, large flexible
- On scroll, apply a fill color to separate from body content
- Can animate on and off screen with another bar of controls, like a row of chips



1. Search app bar
2. Small
3. Medium flexible
4. Large flexible

M3 Expressive update

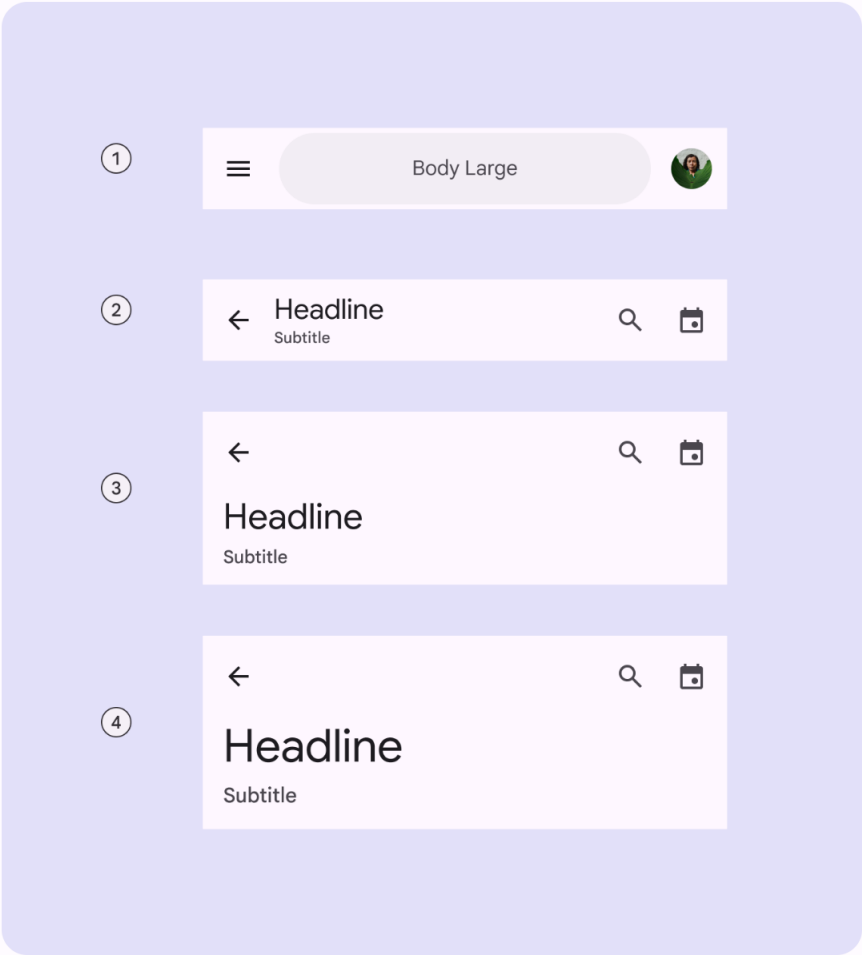
May 2025
The new **search app bar** supports icons inside and outside the search bar, and centered text. It opens the search view component when selected.

The new **medium flexible** and **large flexible** app bars come with significant improvements, and should replace **medium** and **large** app bars, which are no longer recommended. The **small** app bar is updated with the same flexible improvements.

More on M3 Expressive

Variants and naming:

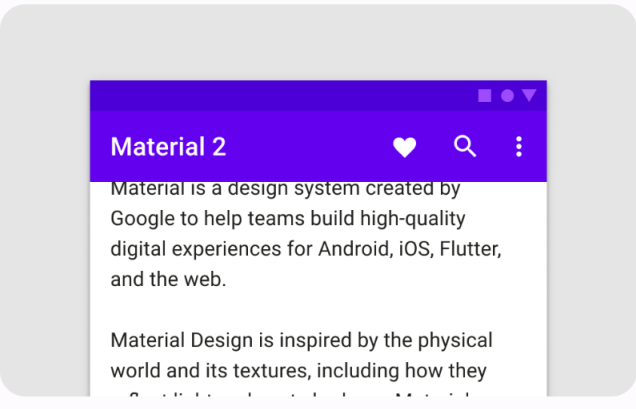
- Renamed component from **top app bar** to **app bar**
- Added **search app bar**
- **Medium** and **large** app bars are no longer recommended
- Added **medium flexible** and **large flexible** app bars with:
  - Reduced overall height
  - Larger title text
  - Subtitle
  - Left- and center-aligned text options
  - Text wrapping
  - More flexible elements for imagery and filled buttons
- Added features to **small** app bar:
  - Subtitle
  - Center-aligned text option
  - More flexible elements for imagery and filled buttons



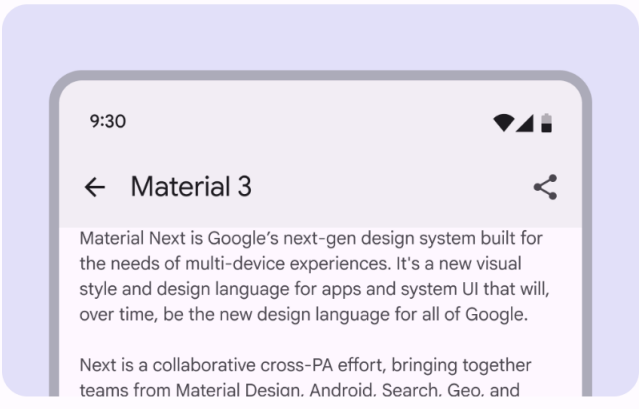
1. Search app bar
2. Small
3. Medium flexible
4. Large flexible

Differences from M2

- Color: New color mappings and compatibility with dynamic color
- On scroll: No drop shadow, instead a color fill creates separation from content
- Typography: Larger default text
- Layout: Smaller default height



M2: Elevation and a drop shadow raise the top app bar when content is present underneath



M3: On scroll, a color fill overlay separates the app bar from the content beneath